



SPACE PHANTOM

THE ADVANCE SCOUT of an alien invasion force from the planet Phantus, the Space Phantom arrived on Earth shortly after the Avengers became a team. The alien quickly realized that he had to eliminate these powerful heroes in order to complete his mission. Like the rest of his highly evolved race, the Space Phantom could instantly assume the physical appearance and powers of any mortal. Whenever he duplicated someone, the original was immediately shunted into Limbo, where he or she remained until the Phantom took on another likeness or returned to his own appearance.



Lost in Limbo

The Space Phantom began his attack on the Avengers by impersonating the Hulk and starting a fight with the rest of the team. But when the Phantom tried to take on Thor's identity, he discovered that his power did not work on immortal Asgardians and found himself in Limbo. After escaping, he joined the Grim Reaper and later became the pawn of Immortus, the lord of Limbo.

The LAVA MEN

DEEP BENEATH the Earth's surface is a network of underground caves called Subterranea, where lives a race of rock-like Lava Men. They possess skin the color of molten lava and can generate intense blasts of heat. They can also expel blasts of volcanic ash and instantly melt metal or turn it into ash. Dissatisfied with their underground existence, the Lava Men often try to invade the surface world, but are always thwarted by the Avengers.



The Living Rock

The Lava Men forced a gigantic "living rock" to the surface, where it caused wholesale destruction by emitting piercing sounds. The Avengers arrived and tricked the Hulk into striking the one spot that destroyed the rock. The Lava Men also attempted to make all the volcanoes on Earth erupt, and later clashed with the Avengers again when a government agency sank a magma tap into the Earth.



LADY-OF-LIGHT
Mistaken by the Lava Men for a sacred figure from their legends, Captain Marvel stopped the battle and arranged a truce.



After Thor, Giant Man, and Iron Man leave the team, the new Avengers realized that they needed the Hulk's power. Their search led them into a confrontation with the Minotaur.

MINOTAUR

THE LEGENDARY MINOTAUR is one of the great beasts of the Earth and is virtually immortal. Half-man and half-bull, it possesses super-strength and is incapable of feeling physical pain. Its hide is also indestructible.

The monster wandered the underground world known as Subterranea for centuries until it found its way to Monster Isle, home of the hate-filled Mole Man. Determined to destroy the Avengers, the Mole Man lured them into a trap and forced them to fight the deadly Minotaur.



Unbeat-a-bull!

Captain America's shield proved useless against the Minotaur's tough hide and so did Hawkeye's arrows. Only by working together could the new team defeat the creature.

MOLE MAN

BEAUTY MAY ONLY BE skin deep, but ugliness can scar forever... the Mole Man knew no one liked him. Women ignored him and his co-workers made fun of him. Disgusted with this treatment, he journeyed to the Bermuda Triangle, entered Subterranea, and became the leader of a race

of Subterraneans. He also learned to control the giant creatures living in the caverns beneath Monster Isle.

Weapon of Mass Destruction

Warned by an ant colony, Giant Man realized that the Mole Man was behind a series of tremors that threatened various locales around the globe. The Avengers responded, only to learn that the Mole Man had allied himself with the Red Ghost, who could become intangible at will. The two villains threatened to destroy all life on Earth—until Giant Man shrank to ant size and sabotaged their doomsday machine.



ARMAGEDDON!

Determined to punish humanity, the Mole Man's atomic gyroscope was designed to set off massive earthquakes around the world.



More Mole Mayhem

After sending the Minotaur against the Avengers, the Mole Man fought for control of Subterranea. He also tried to sink California and raise a new continent. He was briefly imprisoned by the Lava Men and later asked the Avengers to help save his kingdom.

